Following Killing Orders

Re-examining the Roles of the Perpetrators in the Anti-Communist Purge of 1965-66 in Indonesia with Evidence from Disaggregated Geographic Analysis

1 Minute Background

Catalyst: 30 September Movement (G30S)

Morning Oct 1st, six high-ranking generals were abducted and killed by a group referred to as 'Revolutionary Council', who then proclaimed control over the nation at 7:15am.

However, the coup was poorly planned. By 7 pm, General Suharto in the army managed to regain control over all the strategic installations that were initially held by the G30S

Army's tank after the G30S coup in Jakarta

PKI displaying a sign in Jakarta

The PKI (*Partai Komunis Indonesia,* Indonesian Communist Party) was blamed as the mastermind behind the coup, and then nation-wide anti-PKI demonstration and violence broke out. The anti-communist purge began.

Impact: 500k – 1 million killed, more incarcerated

Victims: members of the PKI and their sympathizers, ethnic Chinese, and individuals deemed to be threats to the regime.

Prosecutor: Military (ATTI) and Militia

Indonesian Army:

Pivotal role in the killings

Weapons and Transportation

Execution and Incarceration

Left: General Suharto in 1965
Right: Solders collecting PKI victims

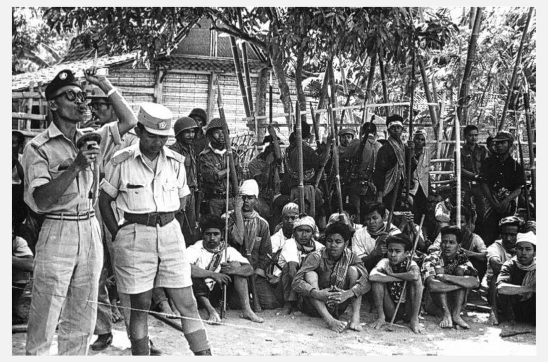
Militia in Indonesia:

Supporting and implementing

Lirboyo pesantren

Pesantren:

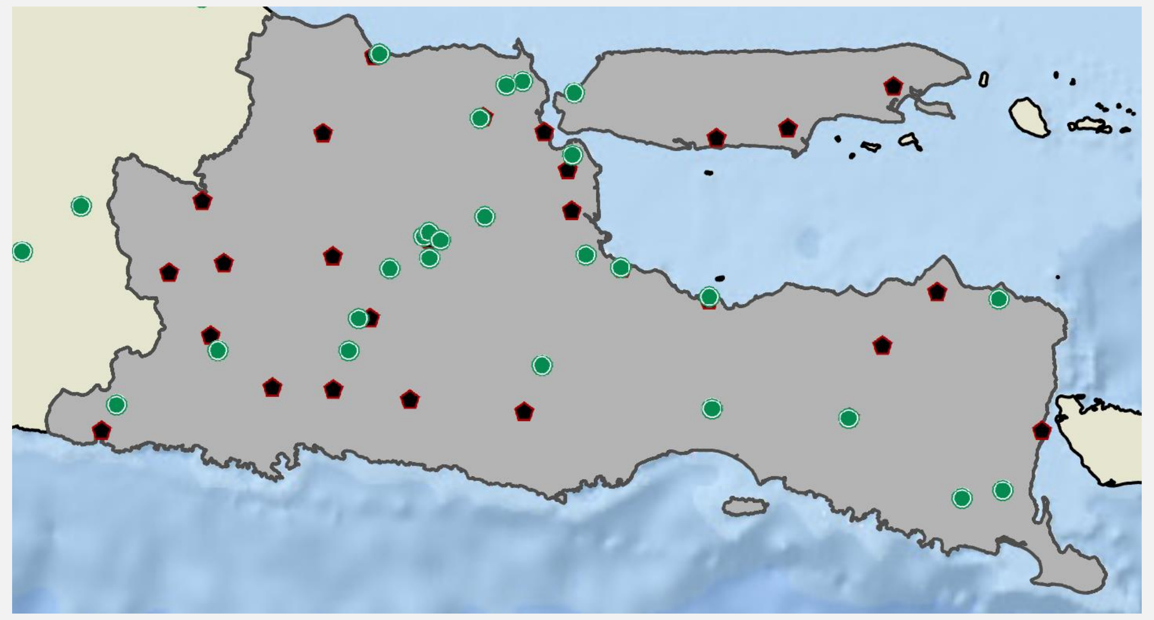
stage of anti-PKI sentiment, backing militia, and camps of the anti-PKI campaign



Cooperation:

Army led, transported, and instigated militia

Militia supported army (information, execution…)



Military Headquarters (kodim)

Islamic Boarding Schools (pesantren)

Research question:

Militia or the army, which group dominated the purge and should take the main responsibility for the killings?

Proxy:

Their influence can be measured by the distance to the local source of influence (kodim/pesantren)

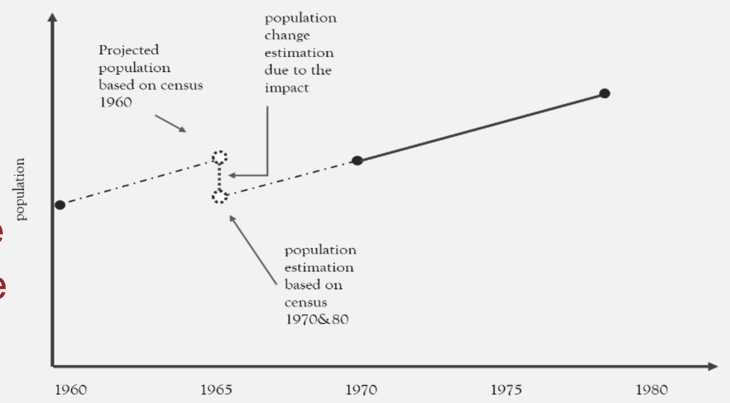
Data and Methods

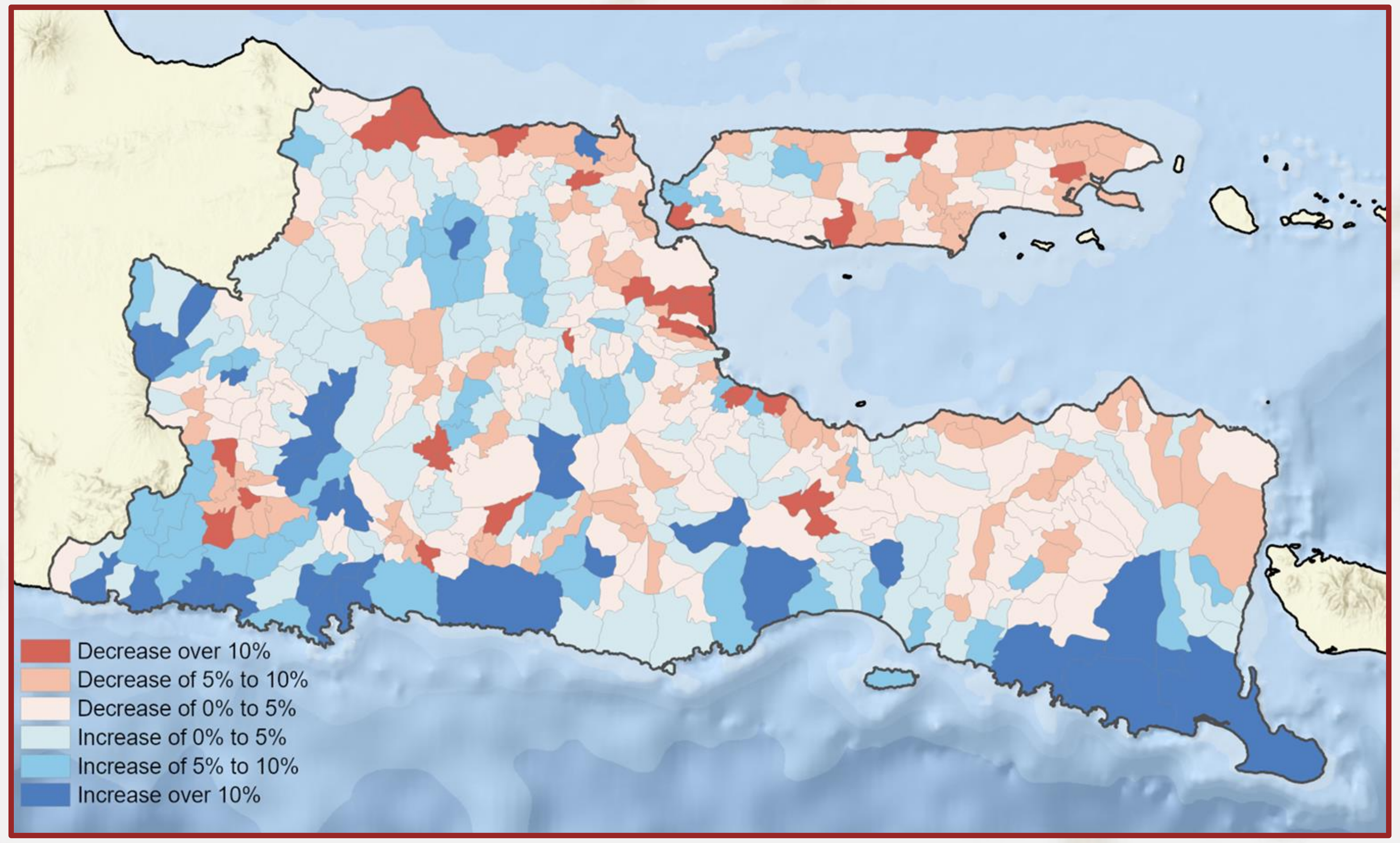
We treat the population change caused by the genocide as a one-time shock

Data (census): 1961, 1971, 1980

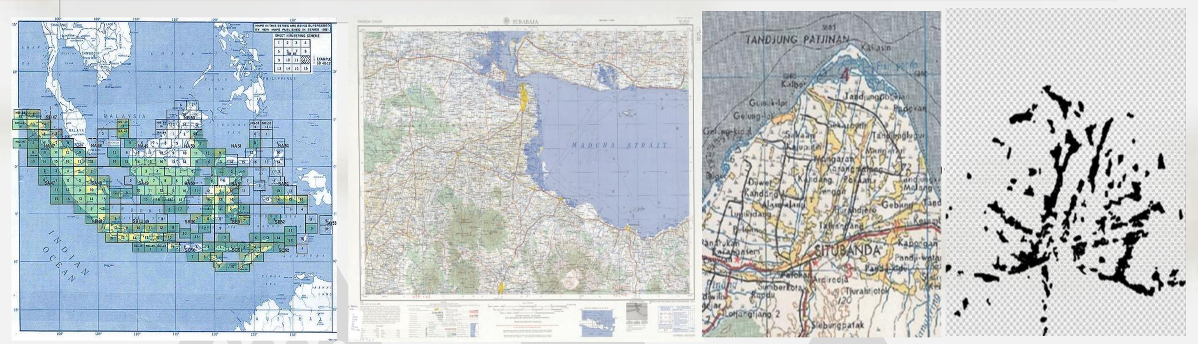
Area of Study: East Java, district level (490 in total),

Method: project/estimate the population in each district at the time of the killing (end 1965), with two sets of data: prior to and after the killings. The gap would be the population change caused by the event.

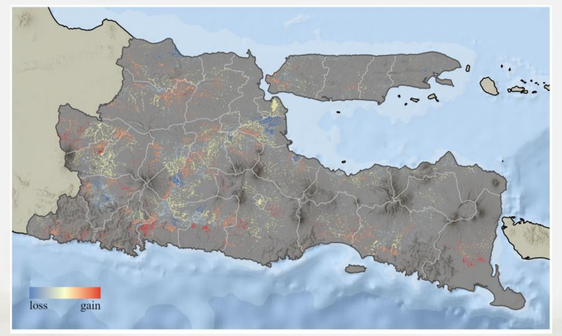




Data extraction: local settlemetns



I used maps from the Army Map Service (AMS), extracted the settlements on the map, and then projected the population change due to the purge onto the settlements



left to right: Index map, AMS map, AMS map zoom-in, the extracted settlements from the zoom-in map, settlements in East Java with data projected

Bayesian Regression

Bayesian Regression

- 1. allow me to leverage existing knowledge while retaining all useful information.
- 2. provide the distribution of the coefficients

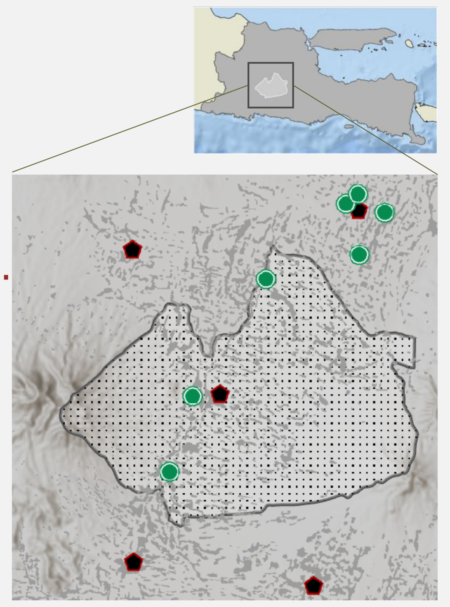
Prior Model:

- Based on existing information or beliefs about the parameters.
- Chosen to reflect prior knowledge or results from previous studies.

$$PopulationChange(\%) = \alpha + \beta_1 * DistanceToKodim + \beta_2 * DistanceToPesantren + \ ...$$

Note: $... = \ +\beta_n ControlVariables + \varepsilon$

Result:		
(intercept)	α	111.5***
KODIM	β_1	.9526***
PESANTREN	β_2	1.004***
…		…



Posterior Model Results

Kodim model: $PopulationChange(\%) = \alpha + \beta_1 * DistanceToKodim + \ ...$

Pesantren model: $PopulationChange(\%) = \alpha + \beta_2 * DistanceToPesantren + \ ...$

Full model/0 model: $PopulationChange(\%) = \alpha + \beta_1 * DistanceToKodim + \beta_2 * DistanceToPesantren + \ ...$

Note: $... = +\beta_n ControlVariables + \varepsilon$

Full Area:

With no control variables, both *kodim* and *pesantren* coefficients were positive as expected. With control, the credible interval of *kodim* (military) was always positive, while *pesantren* not.

Result:		0 MODEL	Kodim	Pesantren	Full
(intercept)	α	-8.3 (-8.6, -8, 1)	-3.3 (-4.4, -2.1)	2.4 (1.2, 3.7)	1.3 (0.2, 2.5)
KODIM	β_1	1.4 (1.4, 1.5)	1.2 (1.2, 1.3)		1.3 (1.2, 1.3)
PESANTREN	β_2	1.4 (1.4, 1.5)		-0.1 (-0.1, -0.1)	-0.2 (-0.2, -0.1)
…(CONTROL)		(Not included)	…	…	…

Regression in Rural Area

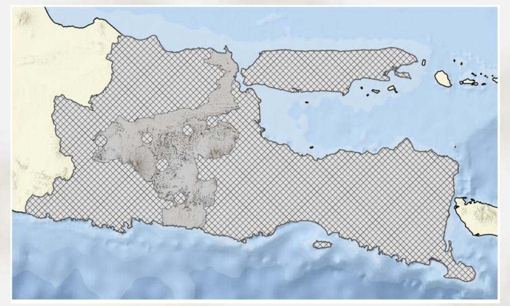
Narrowing down:

1. Muhammadiyah activity in urban areas.
2. Madura data bias: no pesantren yet strong community level anti-PKI

Result:		Kodim	Pesantren	Full
(intercept)	α	-1.5 (-3, -0.1)	1.7 (0.2, 3.1)	1.1 (-0.3, 2.5)
KODIM	β_1	1.3 (1.2, 1.3)		1.2 (1.2, 1.3)
PESANTREN	β_2		0.3 (0.2, 0.3)	0.1 (0, 0.1)
…(CONTROL)		…	…	…

Regression in Area with Documented Evidence:

1. not all the pesantren responsible for the killings.
2. areas with observable evidence (both kodim and pesantren involved)

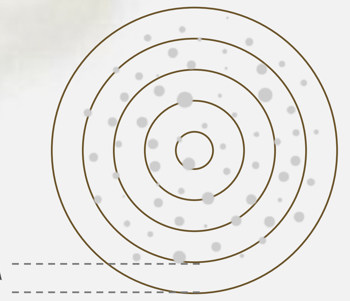


Result:		Kodim	Pesantren	Full
(intercept)	α	2.3 (-0.3, 5.1)	9 (6.4, 11.6)	1.2 (-1.5, 3.7)
KODIM	β_1	1.6 (1.4, 1.7)		1.5 (1.4, 1.7)
PESANTREN	β_2		0.5 (0.4, 0.6)	0.5 (0.4, 0.6)
…(CONTROL)		…	…	…

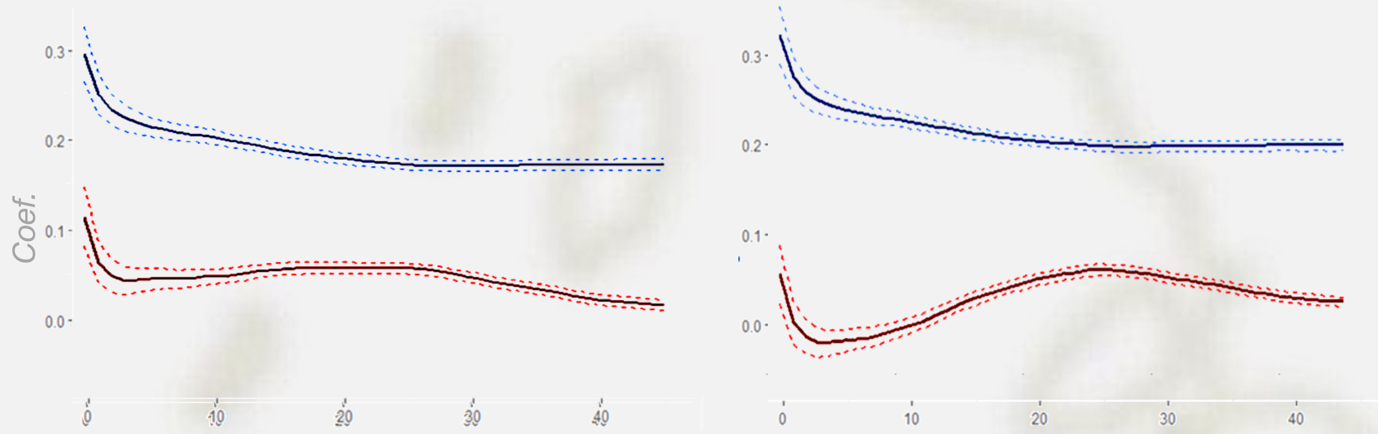
Piecewise Model

Moving window:

Each curve on the right figures depicted the coefficient of 45 regressions. Each regression used data within a 20km-wide ring centered on the closest *kodim* (or *pesantren*).



Nth Ring of Data Selected…



Univariate w/ Control Variables: Bivariate w/ Control Variables:

The military has a stronger impact on all the areas, while the pesantren only have a smaller influence to areas close to the them. Although we expect a monotonic decrease, the abnormality (of an increasing line on the right figure) might be caused by the correlation between these two at some distance.

Note: Y-axis: coefficient of the variable; X: Distance from the source of influence to the ring

Blue Color: coefficients of *kodim*/Military

Red Color: coefficients of *pesantren (Islamic Boarding School)*

Conclusion and Discussion

- Both the *kodim* and *pesantren* had a very likely impact on the purge in rural areas of Java Island.
- The troops from *kodim* seemed to play a much more destructive role than militias trained in the boarding schools
- Islamic boarding schools seemed to have a persistent impact on the killings, especially on the settlements located 25-50 km away from a boarding school
- It is essential to interpret the meaning of influence in this research appropriately – dominating meant to lead, not to kill

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